Course Syllabus

MARK 7550: Social Media Market Strategy (CRN 48646)

Spring 2026

Course Meeting Times

Class Days: Tuesday & Thursday

2:55 – 4:15 218 Correll Hall

Instructor

Instructor: Dr. Jennifer Osbon

Email: jenosbon@uga.edu

Office Hours: MWF by appointment

Course Description & Details

CAPA:

Provides students with an understanding of the history, importance, technology, and strategic uses of social media as a part of marketing strategy. Students will learn how to apply various social media tools and platforms and will understand how to develop and evaluate social media marketing strategies.

Career Focus:

This course is appropriate for all students interested in learning about marketing using social media, current and emerging trends in the digital marketing space, and how it all fits together within a strategic marketing framework. The course is specifically for students who are planning to enter digital or social marketing, consumer-packaged goods, consulting, and brand management roles.

Course Description:

Because today's students are digital natives, the course does not focus on the fundamentals of the technology platforms. Instead, the focus is on the way businesses use social platforms to engage with their audiences. Students will gain insight into the sociological principles behind major shifts in consumer behavior and social interaction online. Through lecture, case studies and hands on projects, students will come away with highly desirable and immediately applicable, practical knowledge for today's work environment. Throughout the course, students will hone their analytical skills to a point where they can examine business activity online, make an informed evaluation of a company's level of digital sophistication and confidently recommend a course of action to achieve stated objectives.

Course Objectives:

By the end of the course, students will:

1. Be familiar with major social media industry trends and innovations, have general knowledge of audience (user) drivers and motivations, and have an awareness of how businesses, both large and small, use digital marketing as a part of their marketing mix
2. Have formed opinions on current trends in the industry and have published work that shows off their digital marketing prowess (a great supplement to your resume)
3. Have completed an individual project where students will create a comprehensive, multi-channel digital marketing campaign for a brand, including the identification of objectives, strategies and tactics as well as creating a detailed marketing schedule and budget and metrics for success.
4. Have prepared for the Meta Blueprint Certified Media Planner Certificate and taken the online practice exam to demonstrate proficiency. *Students are encouraged to take the Official Facebook Exam to become Meta Blueprint Certified although it is not a requirement for the course.*

Required Course materials

TEXTBOOK

There is no book for this course as the industry moves too fast. All material will come from class lectures and slides.

TECHNOLOGY

Since this is a social media course, students will be expected to have and use personal accounts on major social platforms to complete some of the assignments.

Assessment and Grading

- **Individual Project: 35%**

  Students will prepare a comprehensive digital marketing plan including digital marketing strategies and tactics that are likely to achieve specific business goals. The project will include an editorial calendar, budget, and projected return.

- **Exams: 45%**

  There will be three non-cumulative exams equally weighted, collectively counting for 50% of the student's overall grade. The exams will cover material from class lecture. The exams consist of multiple-choice questions and will be taken via the Quiz function on ELC with Respondus Lockdown Browser.

- **Homework/Personal Brand Development: 20%**

  Students will augment their own personal brand on social media by optimizing their LinkedIn profile. This will include defining their personal brand, completing LinkedIn Learning courses, aligning their resume with their personal brand goals, and developing a personal development plan for use post-graduation.

See eLC for more information about each course requirement.

MISSED EXAMS, LATE ASSIGNMENTS, & RE-GRADING REQUESTS

There will be **no makeup exams** offered for any missed assessments. It is the student's responsibility to complete all scheduled exams during the 24-hour window provided. In the event of an emergency or extenuating circumstances, the student should contact the instructor as soon as possible. Consideration for alternative arrangements will be made only under exceptional circumstances and proper documentation may be required.

Please make every attempt to turn in your assignments on the specified dates. Students will incur a **10-point drop per day for any late assignment. Weekend days are included.**

EXTRA CREDIT OPPORTUNITIES

There will be no extra credit offered or accepted. Students should focus on completing the required assignments to the best of their ability. An optional cumulative final exam will be offered for students wishing to improve their final grade. This exam will be averaged with the other exams and the exam portion of the course will remain 45% of your entire grade. ***Note: the optional final exam will be averaged with the other scores. It will not replace the lowest exam score.***

FINAL GRADES

Final class grades will be determined using the following percentage scale. **No curve is offered.**

Percentage (%)	Grade
93 - 100	A
90 - 92.9	A-
87 - 89.9	B+
83 - 86.9	B
80 - 82.9	B-
77 - 79.9	C+
73 - 76.9	C
70 - 72.9	C-
65 - 69.9	D
64.9 and below	F

Course Statements & Policies

UGA Honor Code

As a University of Georgia student, you have agreed to abide by the University's academic honesty policy. All academic work must meet these standards. The UGA Student Honor Code states: *"I will be academically honest in all of my academic work and will not tolerate academic dishonesty of others." A Culture of Honesty, the University's policy and procedures for handling cases of suspected dishonesty, can be found at honesty.uga.edu*. Lack of knowledge of the academic honesty policy is not a reasonable explanation for a violation. Questions related to course assignments and the academic honesty policy should be directed to the instructor.

Accommodation for disabilities

If you plan to request accommodations for a disability, please register with the Disability Resource Center. They can be reached by visiting Clark Howell Hall, calling 706-542-8719 (voice) or 706-542-8778 (TTY), or by visiting http://drc.uga.edu.

Inclusive Excellence

The Terry College of Business is committed to promoting an inclusive learning and working environment among its students, faculty, and staff. This class welcomes the open exchange of ideas and values freedom of thought and expression and provides a professional environment that recognizes the inherent worth of every person. It aims to foster dignity, understanding, and mutual respect among all individuals in the class.

Attendance & Participation Policy

Material for class will be provided via lecture. Slides will be posted on ELC. No attendance record will be kept. Students should be aware however, attending class is crucial to success in this class. 100% of the exam material will be covered during the class lectures.

Use of AI in this Course

Artificial intelligence-based technologies, such as ChatGPT and Microsoft Co-Pilot, may only be utilized for creative development on the course project with prior approval by the instructor, and requires notation within the project. For full details on how to properly cite AI-generated work, please see the APA Style article https://apastyle.apa.org/blog/how-to-cite-chatgpt. The use of AI technologies is expressly prohibited on all other assignments in this course (ie: movie responses). Suspected unauthorized assistance, plagiarism, or other violations of UGA's "A Culture of Honesty" will be reported to the Office of Academic Honesty.

Well-being Resources

UGA Well-being Resources promote student success by cultivating a culture that supports a more active, healthy, and engaged student community.

Anyone needing assistance is encouraged to contact Student Care & Outreach (SCO) in the Division of Student Affairs at 706-542-8479 or visit sco.uga.edu. Student Care & Outreach helps students navigate difficult circumstances by connecting them with the most appropriate resources or services. They also administer the Embark@UGA program which supports students experiencing, or who have experienced, homelessness, foster care, or housing insecurity.

UGA provides both clinical and non-clinical options to support student well-being and mental health, any time, any place. Whether on campus, or studying from home or abroad, UGA Well-being Resources are here to help.

Well-being Resources: well-being.uga.edu

Student Care and Outreach: sco.uga.edu

University Health Center: healthcenter.uga.edu

Counseling and Psychiatric Services: caps.uga.edu or CAPS 24/7 crisis support at 706-542-2273

Health Promotion/ Fontaine Center: healthpromotion.uga.edu

Disability Resource Center and Testing Services: drc.uga.edu

Additional information, including free digital well-being resources, can be accessed through the UGA app or by visiting https://well-being.uga.edu.

Disclaimer

The course syllabus is a general plan for the course; deviations announced to the class by the instructor may be necessary.

Course Schedule & Activities

Spring	**2026**		
		Digital Marketing Strategic Overview	
13-Jan	T	Syllabus Day	
15-Jan	R	Social Media Intro & Tribes Intro & History	
20-Jan	T	Digital MarTech Ecosystems	***LinkedIn Learning Course: Career Planning***
22-Jan	R	Goal & SMART Objectives	
27-Jan	T	**Project Workday**	***Project Topic***
29-Jan	R	Audience Development & Personalization / Project Workday / Exam Review	***Submit your Career Plan and PDP***
3-Feb	T	***EXAM 1***	***EXAM 1***
		Content Marketing, Measurement & Attribution	
5-Feb	R	Content Marketing 101	***LinkedIn Learning: Optimize for ATS***
10-Feb	T	Content Marketing Continued	
12-Feb	R	Influencer Marketing & Word of Mouth	***Fake Famous***
17-Feb	T	Budgets & Returns	***Framework***
19-Feb	R	***Project Workday***	
24-Feb	T	*Project Workday*	
26-Feb	R	*Project Workday*	
3-Mar	T	Marketing Attribution; Optimization & Testing	
5-Mar	R	***EXAM 2***	***Project Due / EXAM 2***
		Platforms & Meta Certification	
10-Mar	T	**NO CLASS MEETING/SPRING BREAK**	
12-Mar	R	**NO CLASS MEETING/SPRING BREAK**	
17-Mar	T	***EXAM 2***	***EXAM 2***
19-Mar	R	Platforms	
24-Mar	T	Meta 1	
26-Mar	R	Meta 2	***LinkedIn Learning Course: Aligned with PDP***
31-Mar	T	Meta 3	
2-Apr	R	Digital Advertising & Programmatic	

		Display, Ecommerce, Hyperlocal & Global Social	
7-Apr	T	Ecommerce & Retail	***LinkedIn Learning: Rock your profile***
9-Apr	R	**NO CLASS MEETING/NYC TRIP**	
14-Apr	T	Hyper Local & Global Social	
16-Apr	R	Brand Safety	
21-Apr	T	***EXAM 3***	***EXAM 3***
23-Apr	R	**Optional Cumulative Exam**	
28-Apr	T	**READING DAY**	